

This roadmap
online

M.A. in Music roadmap

Four semesters of full-time study, 8 units a semester · Graduate Coordinator: Inés Thiebaut,
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Degree	Total	Emphases	Catalog
Master of Arts in Music	32 units	Performance (Classical or Jazz), Choral Conducting, Composition	2027-2028

01 Degree at a glance

Component	Units
Graduate seminars (eight courses)	16
Graduate Applied Study (MUS 661-668)	8
Ensemble (MUS 351-355, 360-369, four semesters)	4
Capstone (MUS 693, four semesters)	4
Total	32

Note

FAST B.A./M.A. students follow the FAST roadmaps. The Single Subject Matter Preparation Certificate in Music can be added to the M.A.

02 Milestones

Advancement to candidacy is at the end of the first year, after 2 units from MUS 601 or MUS 602, 2 units from MUS 604, MUS 605, or MUS 631, 4 units of Graduate Applied Study, and 2 units of ensemble, with a grade point average of at least 3.0. It must be on record before the final semester.

The capstone (a public recital, conducting performance, or lecture on a composition portfolio, by emphasis) and the comprehensive examination are in the final semester. The examination is a degree requirement that has no units.

2026-2027 cohort

In the 2026-2027 catalog, MUS 603 is 3 units, and MUS 693 Capstone is 3 units over three semesters. The M.A. is 32 units in both catalogs.

03 Semester by semester

First semester (fall A)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 601	Analysis of Musical Styles: Birth and Death of Tonality	2
MUS 603	Entrepreneurship in the Arts	2
MUS 661-668	Graduate Applied Study	2
MUS 351-355, 360-369	Ensemble	1
MUS 693	Capstone, 1 of 4	1
Semester total		8

Third semester (fall B)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 602	Analysis of Musical Styles: Post-Tonality and Beyond	2
MUS 630	Advanced Conducting	2
MUS 661-668	Graduate Applied Study	2
MUS 351-355, 360-369	Ensemble	1
MUS 693	Capstone, 3 of 4	1
Semester total		8

Second semester (spring A)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 605	History and Theory of Jazz	2
MUS 606	Interdisciplinary Collaboration in Music	2
MUS 661-668	Graduate Applied Study	2
MUS 351-355, 360-369	Ensemble	1
MUS 693	Capstone, 2 of 4	1
Semester total		8

Fourth semester (spring B)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 631	Teaching Music in Higher Education	2
MUS 604	Sounding Justice: Unveiling the Ecological and Social Dimensions of Music	2
MUS 661-668	Graduate Applied Study	2
MUS 351-355, 360-369	Ensemble	1
MUS 693	Capstone, 4 of 4	1

Course	Title	Units
Semester total		8